and expeditious, but it is still significant how *little* the Shansabanis actually built anew in the ex-Ghaznavid domains. I argue in Chapter 6 that, as the Ghazna Shansabanis successfully campaigned eastward, they implemented this preferred mode of building empire through re-inscription on an exponentially larger scale. Along the valleys and plains intimately linked with the Indus River, Mu'izz al-Din's followers commissioned small, usually funerary structures, but their conquests of the region at large were substantiated principally through the re-inscription of entire urban environments and landscapes, and the minting of coins – all of which had previously been *in*scribed with a Yamini–Ghaznavid presence for nearly two centuries.

Whether through annexation of previously unclaimed (or at least unmarked) territories, or the above-described process of re-inscription, a fundamental resource for the implementation of the Shansabanis' imperial expansion was the repository of religious, theological, and legal knowledge possessed by the 'ulama' and other scholars in their retinues. Arguably, among the more palpable indices of these intellectual elites' participation in empire-building were the epigraphic programs gracing Shansabani-patronized architectural projects. Chapter 4, proposed that, in addition to the skilled manual labor required in monumental building, equally skilled *intellectual* labor was instrumental in crafting the overall imperial affiliations and specific religio-theological messages these monuments proclaimed.

The architectural complexes associated with the Firuzkuh Shansabanis exhibited these intellectual laborers' contributions in the meaningful religious/theological content, which could have been selected only by scholars knowledgeable in the Qur'an, Hadith compilations, and exegetical literature. Thereafter, Mu'izz al-Din apparently carried forward the inscriptional corpus – albeit small, as it can only be gleaned from the Firuzkuh Shansabanis' building projects that still survive – into Zabulistan and Zamindawar as he laid claim to the Yamini–Ghaznavids' imperial centers. Moreover, the nusualness of the epigraphic content on the magnificent arch at Bust could indicate the intellectual elites' continued contributions to a growing corpus of favored epigraphy. Mu'izz al-Din and/or the intelligentsia in his service evidently implemented the small epigraphic corpus associable with the Shansabanis in these annexed territories – and also farther eastward throughout the Indus's alluvia. Here, with re-inscription being the Ghazna Shansabanis' principal mode of imperial consolidation, the architecture they *did* patronize, as well as these buildings' epigraphic programs, both become that much more significant (see Chapter 6).

A closer, more granular perspective on the architectural interventions discussed throughout this chapter yields additional, valuable observations. Overall, the Ghazna Shansabanis' re-inscriptions took place in royal and palatial contexts: these encompassed the probable renovation of the "Palace